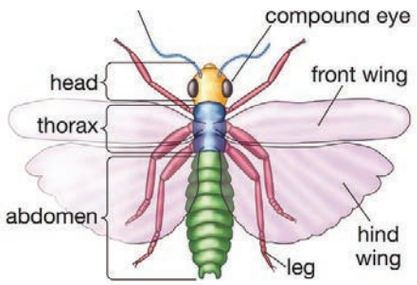
Structure of Insects

Insects have three main body regions. They are;

Head, thorax, and the abdomen. All parts of the insect are inside an exoskeleton.



- **Head** The main visible parts on the head are the large compound eyes, the antennae (feelers) and the mouth parts.
- **Thorax** The thorax is the middle region of the body. It bears three pairs of legs and two pairs of wings.
- **Abdomen** The abdomen is the last part of the insect body. Abdomen of most of the insects have clear segmentation.

Insects have differences in structures like wings, legs, antennae and mouthparts. The legs are modified for walking, jumping, digging or swimming.

Most of the insects have wings which can be folded flat over their body. E.g. Bug There are some insects which cannot fold their wings. E.g. Dragonfly. Some insects are wingless. E.g. Silverfish.







The compound eyes of insects are made up of small units called ommatidia.



ACTIVITY **Fill in the missing words.**

Butterfly has three body parts like all other insects the _____, the _____ (chest), and the _____ (bottom). The butterfly has four _____ and six legs, attached to the throax. Butterfly uses its two _____ to smell.

4th Science Unit 2_Animals .indd 83 11/12/2019 12:13:34 PM